



COODU TRUST

ANNUAL REPORT 2017-
18

ABOUT US

Coodu Trust was established in the year 2000 to address the pressing demands of farmers, women, youth, and children – predominantly from rural areas and among urban poor. Its focus is on improving the quality of life of the “last man in the last row”. Drawing professionals from a wide multi-disciplinary team, *Coodu Trust* is equipped with a multi-faceted and trained Task Force and includes community members in the planning, implementation and evaluation stages making overall community development truly participatory and inclusive.

Coodu Trust is implementing projects under different verticals, such as Soil and Water Conservation, Watershed Development, Sustainable Livelihoods, Gender Empowerment, Entrepreneurship Development through Skilling, Health and Nutrition, Water Sanitation and Hygiene (WASH), Aged care, Education, Livestock Management and Environment & Climate Change.

OUR VISION

“Implement sustainable practices in all sectors to Enthuse, Equip and Enable communities to become self-sufficient”.

OUR PHILOSOPHY

Agriculture is the mainstay of the economy and it is important to educate and train farmers in best practices to enable to follow sustainable agricultural practices thereby improving yield, enhancing income and leading to all-round growth and development of the individuals and community to which they belong.

Similarly, industry also forms the backbone of any economy and for it to grow, there is a need to build a strong, educated and skilled workforce. To that end it is important that all educated youth are appropriately trained and exposed to an environment so as to be able to fit in roles and perform jobs effectively. Thus, *Coodu Trust* strongly believes that the workforce needs to be ‘industry-prepared’ and hence continuous capacity building of manpower is key to greater industrialization.

OUR STRATEGY

The core strategy to which *Coodu Trust* prescribes is around the key mantras of ‘**Connect**’ [to key stakeholders across the social development spectrum], ‘**Organize**’ [rural and urban communities around development activities], ‘**Optimize**’ [resources – human, infrastructural, technical, energy, finance, etc.], ‘**Design**’ [need-based interventions across verticals], and ‘**Unlearn**’ [from local knowledge of community] specific project activities. *Coodu Trust* strongly believes that panchayat development is the fulcrum of rural development.

GOVERNANCE

Village Panchayat Development Plan [VPDP]

The VPDP project in Dindigul district aims at developing and designing community based integrated sustainable development plan in the villages, with improved health & sanitation, nutrition, and livelihood status with focus on women, children and youth. Coodu Trust conducted training at various levels to cross-section of stakeholders on preparation of the VPDP, participatory planning methods, plan preparation and budgeting. The following trainings were conducted:

1. District Level Training Programme – 172 participants including BDOs, AEs, Zonal Deputy BDOs
2. Block Level Training Programme for field functionaries – 285 participants including Gram Panchayat Secretaries, Overseers & RIs
3. Line Department Training Programme for field functionaries – 1472 participants including VHNs, AWWs, HMs & VAOs
4. Village Level Campaigns – 30600 participants including VHNs, AWWs, VAOs & public
5. Village Planning Team – 1836 participants including Self Help Groups, Panchayat Level Federations, Village Panchayat Resource Centre & Community Resource persons

WATERSHED MANAGEMENT

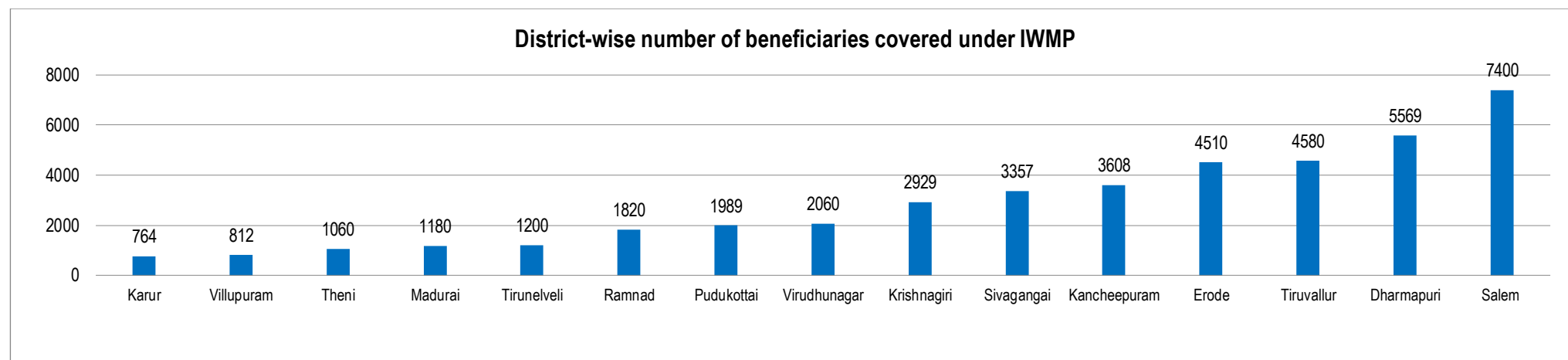
Agriculture – Soil & Water Conservation

Conservation of soil and water resources is important for sustainability of agriculture and environment. Soil and water resources are under immense pressure due to ever increasing population thereby ensuing growing demand for food, fibre and shelter. They are being deteriorated due to different anthropogenic and natural factors. Soil erosion is one of the several major deteriorative processes which results in deterioration of the soil. It is the removal of soil due to movement of water and/ or air. Soil erosion may lead to the significant loss of soil productivity and thus may lead to the desertification under sever conditions. Water and wind are the major agencies which are responsible of soil erosion. Deforestation, over-grazing, intensive cultivation, mismanagement of cultivated soils and intensive urbanization are major factors triggering the soil erosion. For sustainable agriculture and environment, it is pertinent to protect the soil resources against erosion. Different control measures should be adopted to protect the soil resources against erosion. The concept of soil conservation cannot be materialized without conserving and efficient use of water resources. It is therefore pre-requisite that soil conservation practices should be adopted. Soil conservation practice include soil management, crop management, engineering, range management and forestry operations.

Integrated Watershed Management Programme [IWMP]

Coodu Trust has implemented Watershed Development Programmes through different government schemes in 570 watersheds in 14 districts covering 33,500 hectares including roughly 1,70,000 households with a population in excess of 8,50,000 persons across Tamil Nadu.

Diagram-1: District-wise number of beneficiaries under Integrated Watershed Development Programme



The following are a key listing of achievements in the watershed development sector:

Training & Capacity Building

- Post-project management
- Training in monitoring & evaluation
- Training exit protocol
- Human Resource Management
- DPR preparation
- Awareness on water & soil conservation

Agriculture

- Nursery techniques, valued addition, orchard cultivation
- Farm production systems
- Exposure to drip irrigation system in orchard crops
- Training on engineering structures, designing & mapping
- Watershed management
- Web-based agriculture training
- Agri-business centre
- Organic farming
- Agri-business & marketing
- Dry-land agriculture
- Precision farming
- Organic vegetable cultivation
- Training on System of Rice Intensification [SRI]
- Training on System of Sugarcane Intensification [SSI]
- Water harvesting structures
- Recharge measurements

Livelihoods Sustenance

- Income Generating programmes
- Small skill development interventions
- Pisci-culture
- Vermicomposting
- Bee keeping
- Tailoring
- Post-harvest techniques
- Livelihood support systems, farm production & micro entrepreneurship development
- Women entrepreneurship training programme
- Millet-based snacks & foods

Veterinary services

- Cattle farm
- Calf rearing
- Azolla fodder creation
- Fodder management
- Veterinary camps
- Poultry management

Book keeping & Records

- Record management
- Record maintenance & accounting
- Records/ registers maintenance

RAINWATER HARVESTING & WATER BUDGETING

Rainwater harvesting and water budgeting of crops was given 125 farmers in Tirunelveli district.

SUSTAINABLE LIVELIHOODS

Entrepreneurship Development

Entrepreneurship development (ED) refers to the process of enhancing entrepreneurial skills and knowledge through structured training and institution-building programmes. It basically aims to enlarge the base of entrepreneurs in order to hasten the pace at which new ventures are created. This accelerates employment generation and economic development.

ED focuses on the individual who wishes to start or expand a business. Small and medium enterprise (SME) development, on the other hand, it also focuses on developing the enterprise, whether or not it employs or is led by individuals who can be considered entrepreneurial.

560 farm beneficiaries in Dindigul, Karur and Salem districts of Tamil Nadu. The training was conducted for two hundred hours and 30 persons per batch. Among 560 beneficiaries 461 obtained the certificates from NSDC, New Delhi.

Veterinary services

12 animal health camps were organized in 12 panchayats of Dindigul, Karur, Tirunelveli and Salem districts.

Skill Training Programme

Apparel Industry

Within the apparel sector Coodu Trust organized skill training on Basic Sewing Machine Operator training under National Urban Livelihood Mission [NULM] to 145 members in Coimbatore, Tirunelveli districts and under RURBAN in Tirunelveli and Sivagangai districts.

Beauty Therapy & Hair Dressing

Beautician training courses were conducted for 2 batches in Coimbatore district under NULM benefiting 60 persons, 2 batches in Tirunelveli district under RURBAN.

Accounts Training

Training on Accounts Assistants using Tally software for 3 batches under NULM was conducted in Coimbatore & Tirunelveli districts.

Table-1: Impact of Schemes of beneficiaries and placement

Scheme	# Beneficiaries trained	# Assessed and Certified	# Beneficiaries Placed
PMKVY	540	460	437
TNSDC	300	291	241
NULM	526	526	476
RURBAN	644	644	463
IWMP	40	40	22

Micro-Finance & Financial Inclusion

Under Mahalir Thittam Project, Training on financial Inclusion was given to 50 SHGs of Kadavur and Thogamalai blocks. Micro finance management- 67 SHGs of Karur District was linked to nationalized bank for getting financial loan of Rs.1.33 crores for rearing cows.

HEALTH

Medical health services – Primary healthcare

One medical health campaign per watershed for 20 villages was organized with Rotary club and Lions club of Dindigul and Tirunelveli districts.

Nutrition

Nutrient garden was established in 15 schools of Athoor and Nilakottai blocks, Dindigul district

Yoga & Wellness

Awareness on Yoga was conducted to 300 students of Gandhigram Rural Institute Gandhigram along with Valga Valamudan

Ambulatory & Mortuary services

Around 137 persons who died were taken to home from hospital and then to cremation ground at free of cost in Dindigul district.

WATER, SANITATION & HYGIENE [WASH]

Water Testing Lab

Through the Tamil Nadu Water Supply & Drainage Board [TWAD] 6000 samples were tested from Sattur [Virudhuagar district] and Valliyoor [Tirunelveli district].

Swachh Bharath Scheme [Community]

Training on Clean Environment and Self hygiene was given to 50 elected Panchayat members of Salem district

School drinking water sanitation & hygiene programme

Around 200 students and teachers from 5 schools in Trichy district were trained on water quality using FWTK Health and Hygiene and Rain Water Harvesting under community development.

EMPOWERMENT

Consumer Rights Protection

Awareness creation on Consumer rights were given to 200 members of public

PROTECTION

Short stay home for farmers, other target groups

210 rural peasants benefitted in the short stay, Counselling and food

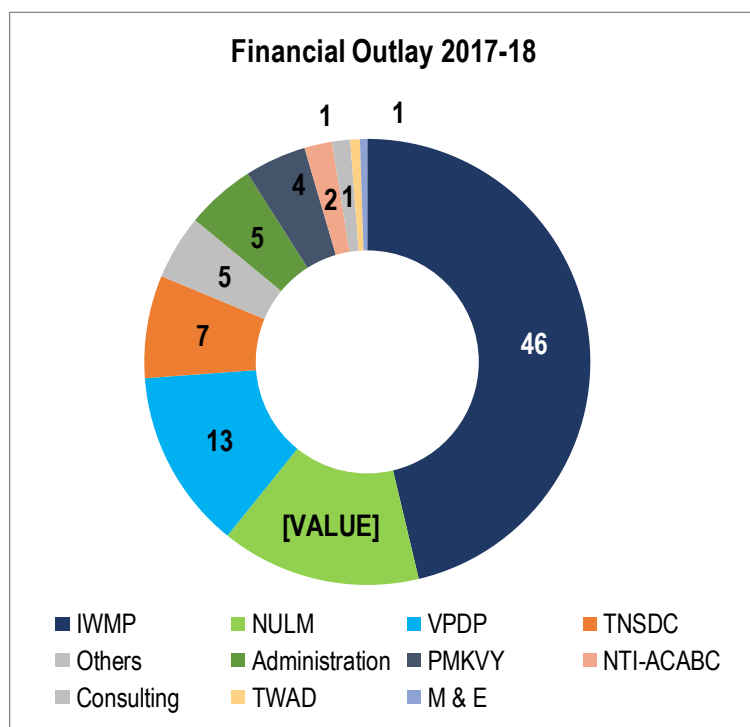
INTER-DISCIPLINARY

Celebration of important days

1. Environmental day-600 tree seedlings were planted
2. Women day-Awareness on Yoga was given to 300 rural women

3. World AIDS day-100 positive people were imparted with knowledge on Nutrient management for long life. Nutrient kits were given to the individual

FINANCIAL PERFORMANCE



The financial performance outlay of *Coodu Trust* for the year 2017-18 indicates that a large proportion of funds have been expended on grassroots level rural and urban development activities. Almost half the project funds [46%] were spent for watershed activities including dry-land agriculture farming practices, in-situ soil & water conservation activities, and post-production and harvest activities.

This is followed by National Urban Livelihoods Mission [NULM] [14%], Village Panchayat Development Project under Women Development Corporation [13%] and Tamil Nadu Skill Development Corporation [TSDC] [7%]. Further, while other projects expenditure amounted to 5 percent, administration

expenses accrued to 5% and it tapered to 4 percent in PMKVY and 2 percent in Nodal Training Institute's AgriClinics and Agri-Business Centers (AC&ABC) Scheme at Dindigul, Tamil Nadu with MANAGE collaboration. Consulting, TWAD Board and Monitoring & Evaluation project expenses equalled 1 percent of overall financial outlay for the year 2017-18.

IMPACT

IWMP

570	42,838	33,500	1,70,000	8,50,000
Watersheds	Beneficiaries	Hectares	Households	Population

VPDP

172	285	1,836	30,600
District Level Trainings	Block Level Trainings	Village Planning Teams trained	Village Beneficiaries

OUR SUPPORTERS

